L-T-48D
January 20, 1975
SUPERSEDING
Int. Fed. Spec. L-T-0048C(GSA-FSS)
July 12, 1967, and
Fed. Spec. L-T-48B
March 24, 1959

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

TABLEWARE, PLASTIC

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers plastic tableware suitable for use in dining halls, hospitals, and in the field.

1.2 Classification. Plastic tableware shall be of the following classes, items, and colors, as specified (see 6.2):

Classes:

1 - Melamine formaldehyde with alpha cellulose filler.
2 - Phenol-modified melamine formaldehyde with chopped cotton-cloth filler.

Items:

4 - Bowl, eating, general purpose, 17-ounce (see fig. 3).
5 - Platter, food-serving, oval, 10-1/2 inches by 15 inches, 1 inch high (see fig. 3).
7 - Tumbler, drinking, 10-ounce capacity (see fig. 5).
8 - Cup, drinking, 1 handle, 10-ounce capacity, (see fig. 5).
10 - Bowl, food serving, fruit, 6-1/2-ounce (see fig. 7).
11 - Bowl, sugar, 11-ounce with cover (see fig. 8).
12 - Dish, food serving, vegetable, 1-quart (see fig. 9).
13 - Pitcher, cream, 8-ounce, (see fig. 10).
15 - Plate, eating, bread and butter (see fig. 12).
16 - Plate, eating, dinner, (see fig. 13) (class 1 only).
17 - Cup, drinking, 8-ounce capacity (se fig. 16).
18 - Saucer, cup, matching (for use with item 17) (see fig. 14).
20 - Bowl, eating, general purpose, 15-ounce (see fig. 17).
24 - Bowl, eating, fruit, 4-1/2 oz. capacity (see fig. 21).

Colors (see 3.6.1):

Green
Sahara Sand
Mottled Tan

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

L-M-181 - Melamine Molded Plastics.
UU-P-268 - Paper, Kraft, Untreated, Wrapping.
PPP-B-636 - Boxes, Shipping, Fiberboard.
PPP-T-42 - Tape, Packaging, Paper (Light Duty Packaging and Bundling).
PPP-T-45 - Tape, Gummed, Paper, Reinforced and Plain, For Sealing and Securing.
PPP-T-76 - Tape, Pressure-sensitive Adhesive Paper, (For Carton Sealing).

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Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Std. No. 595 - Colors.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

U.S. Army Natick Laboratory Drawings:

5-13-1750 - Tableware, Plastic; Bowl, Eating, General Purpose, 17-Ounce.
5-13-1752 - Tableware, Plastic; Cup Drinking, 1-Handle and Tumbler, Drinking.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza., Chicago, IL 60606.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Standard product. The tableware shall be the current standard product of the manufacturer, except for any modifications specified herein.

3.1.1 Illustrative figures. Except for items 4, 7, and 8, figures are illustrative only and are not intended to preclude any commercial design otherwise conforming to specification requirements specified herein. Figures for items 4, 7, and 8 are miniature reproductions of drawings referenced in 2.1 and are attached for information only.

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3.2 Preproduction sample. When specified (see 6.2), before production is commenced, four samples of each item of tableware shall be submitted or made available to the contracting officer or his authorized representative for approval in accordance with 4.2. The approval of the preproduction sample authorizes the commencement of production, but does not relieve the supplier of responsibility for compliance with all applicable provisions of this specification. The preproduction sample shall be manufactured in the same facilities to be used for the manufacture of the production items.

3.3 Material.

3.3.1 Class 1 tableware. The molding compound used for manufacturing class 1 tableware shall conform to type I of L-M-181, except that the electrical property requirements under table I shall not apply.

3.3.2 Class 2 tableware. The molding compound used for manufacturing class 2 tableware shall conform to type IV of L-M-181, except that the electrical property requirements under table II shall not apply. The phenol content of the compound shall not exceed 18 percent.

3.3.3 The use of any previously cured and reground scrap material in the molding compounds is prohibited. The contractor shall furnish a certificate of compliance to the contracting officer showing that the molding compound used in the manufacture of the items complies with the requirements of 3.3. The certificate shall show the actual test values obtained on the material.

3.4 Dimensions. The dimensions of tableware items shall be as shown on applicable drawings.

3.5 Construction. All tableware items shall be molded from molding compound specified in 3.3.1 or 3.3.2 for classes 1 and 2, respectively, as specified. The tableware shall be capable of withstanding the applicable tests specified in 4.5.

3.6 Color and finish.

3.6.1 Color.

3.6.1.1 Classes 1 and 2 tableware shall in accordance with the standard color chips to Fed. Std. No. 595. Each of the following colors shall be within its range of color numbers as shown below:

Green	Nos. 24525, 24504, and 24533
Sahara sand	Nos. 33717, 33711, and 23613
Mottled tan	See 3.6.1.2

3.6.1.2 The lighter colored areas of mottled tan tableware shall be within the range of tan color numbers 20450, 21643, 22563, and 23531 of Fed. Std. No. 595. The darker colored areas shall be within the range of brown color numbers 20140, 20219, 20227, and 20313 of Fed. Std. No. 595.

3.6.2 Finish. The surface of the tableware items shall have a uniformly high luster throughout, produced by molding. No surface shall be painted or otherwise treated with a protective coating or other adulterant. No machining of surfaces shall be permitted except for removal of flash at dividing line of mold. Flash or parting line after machining shall be burnished.

3.7 Uniformity. All items of tableware shall be uniform in texture, finish, gloss density, color and shade, and other properties. No particles of metal, cured resin flash, dirt or synthetic materials in the form of fabric, yarn, or thread which cause imperfections in the molded item will be permitted. Dark spots caused by dark-colored cotton materials shall be permitted on class 2 material to the extent described herein only.

3.7.1 Inside surfaces of tableware (side on which food or liquid is placed), class 2. No dark spot more than 1/4 inch in largest dimension will be permitted on any class 2 tableware items. For the food-serving platter no more than 6 spots and for all other items no more than 4 spots of a size larger than 1/8 inch but smaller than 1/4 inch in largest dimension, will be permitted. For the food-serving platter no more than 12 spots of any size and for all other items no more than 9 spots of any size, visible when observed at arm's length, will be permitted.

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3.8 Resistance to boiling water. Items of finished tableware shall show no cracks, chalking, changes of color, or any other defects impairing serviceability or appearance (see 4.5.1).

3.9 Resistance to boiling sulfuric acid solution. Items or test specimens cut from the tableware items shall show no chalking when tested as specified in 4.5.2.

3.10 Warpage, food-serving platter. Warpage of the food-serving platter shall not be greater than 0.0625 inch when measured as specified in 4.5.3.

3.11 Resistance to dry heat. Tableware items shall show no cracks, color change, or blisters when tested as specified in 4.5.4.

3.12 Odor (class 2 only). Tableware items shall not have an objectionable odor and when tested as specified in 4.5.5, shall not develop an objectionable odor. The characteristic odor of phenol or formaldehyde will be cause for rejection.

3.13 Marking for identification. Tableware items shall be permanently and distinctly marked by an embossed molded-in-process marking with manufacturer's name or trademark. Marking shall be located so as not to detract from appearance of the tableware items.

3.14 Workmanship. The finished tableware shall have rounded edges and shall be clean, well made, and free from warpage. Tableware shall be free from any defects which may affect appearance or serviceability.

3.15 Knockout pin marks. Knockout pin marks, if hidden under normal use of item, shall not protrude more than 1/32 inch above or extend more than 1/64 inch into the surface of the item or affect stability of item when resting on a flat surface. Knockout pin marks, if not hidden under normal use of item, shall not protrude above, or extend into, the surface of the item more than 1/64 inch.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Preproduction sample. When a preproduction sample is required it shall be examined in accordance with 4.4.1, 4.4.2 and tested in accordance with 4.5.1 through 4.5.5, as applicable. The presence of any defect, any dimension not within specified tolerance, or failure of any test shall be cause for rejection of the sample.

4.3 Sampling. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be made in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated hereinafter.

4.3.1 Lot. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), a lot shall consist of all tableware of the same class, item, and color submitted for inspection at the same time. The sample unit shall be one completely fabricated end item.

4.3.2 Sampling for inspection. Sampling shall be as follows:

Requirement	Level
4.4.1	I
4.4.2	S-2

4.3.3 Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be in accordance with level S-2, except where otherwise indicated.

4.4 Inspection.

4.4.1 End item. Tableware shall be examined for defects listed in table I. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 4.0 for major defects and 10.0 for total defects, expressed as defects per hundred units.

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TABLE I. Classification of defects, end item

Examine	Defect	Classification: Major	Classification: Minor
Tableware	Scuffed or abraded area	X	
	Scratch	X	
	Dent	X	
	Crack or fracture	X	
	Chalking	X	
	Pinhole	X	
	Blister	X	
	Wrinkle	X	
	Pit	X	
	Flow mark		X
	Shrinkage	X	
	Unfilled area	X	
	Chipped	X	
	Presence of mechanical oil or grease, dirt, wood shavings, metal chips, or other foreign matter	X	
	Checked	X	
Knockout pin marks	Protrude more than 1/32 inch above surface of item, if mark is hidden, or more than 1/64 inch if mark is not hidden		X
	Extend more than 1/64 inch into surface of item		X
	Affect stability of the item when item is resting on flat surface	X	
Luster	Lacks luster (dull)	X	
	Not uniform high luster throughout		X
Color	Not specified color	X	
	Lack of uniformity of color and shade within established tolerances		X
Spots: Class 2	Dark spots caused by material other than dark-colored cotton materials		X
Inside surfaces (side in which food or liquid is placed)	Any dark spot larger than 1/4 inch in largest dimension	X	
	More than 6 dark spots on food-serving platter, 4 dark spots on all other items larger than 1/8 inch but less than 1/4 inch in largest dimension	X	
	More than 12 dark spots of any size on food-serving platter when visible at arm's length	X	
	More than 9 dark spots of any size on all other items when visible at arm's length	X	
Outside surfaces	Any dark spot larger than 1/4 inch in largest dimension		X
	More than 6 dark spots on food-serving platter, 4 dark spots on all other items larger than 1/8 inch but less than 1/4 inch in largest dimension		X
	More than 15 dark spots of any size on food-serving platter when visible at arm's length		X
	More than 12 dark spots of any size on all other items when visible at arm's length		X

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TABLE I. Classification of defects, end item (con.)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Classification Minor
Texture and finish	Presence of any finishing coating	X	
	Orange peel	X	
	Lack of uniformity in texture and finish	X	
	NOTE: Texture may be considered as referring to the fine detail of structure, for example: A mottled effect due to the random arrangement of color areas along with lighter areas due to the cotton-cloth filler, the whole forming a pattern of normal size. In addition, an apparent matting of surface fibers becomes evident when viewed at certain angles indicating the mirror reflecting character of the surface.		
Construction Material	Not plastic	X	
	Presence of particles of metal, cured resin flash, dirt, or synthetic materials in the form of fabric, yarn or thread which cause imperfections in molded items	X	
Corners and edges	Sharp	X	
	Not "broken" and polished		X
Surfaces and curves	Not blended smoothly		X
Foot rings, as required (see drawings)	Missing	X	
	Not specified number of segments	X	
	Not smoothly blended into body		X
	Blending not started at specified spoints		X
Flashline	Not machined or burnished		X
	Insufficiently ground and burnished		X
Stacking feature (when applicable)	Stacking lugs missing	X	
	Out of position	X	
	Like units fail to stack firmly and evenly	X	
	Poor nesting resulting in restricted air circulation (for drying purposes)	X	
Handle when required)	Missing	X	
	Not in specified location	X	
Identification marking	Not permanently marked by an embossed molding process		X
	Missing		X
	Illegible		X
	Incorrect		X

4.4.2 Dimensions. Tableware shall be measured dimensionally for compliance with 3.4. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 10.0, expressed in defects per hundred unit.

4.4.3 Inspection of preparation for delivery. An inspection shall be made to determine that the packaging, packing and marking comply with the requirements in section 5 of this specification. Defects shall be scored in accordance with table II. For examination of interior packaging the sample unit shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery, selected at random just prior to the closing operations. Sampling shall be in accord-with MIL-STD-105. Defects of closure listed shall be examined on shipping containers fully prepared for delivery. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 defects per hundred units.

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TABLE II. Classification of preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defect
Marking	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Material	Any component missing, damaged or not conforming to the applicable specification or requirements stated herein.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as loose strapping, incomplete closure of container flaps, inadequate stapling or distortion of container.
Contents	Quantity per container is more or less than required. Gross weight exceeds the requirements of the box specification.

4.4.4 Testing of the end item. Tableware selected in accordance with 4.3.3 shall be tested as specified in 4.5. Failure of any one item shall be cause for rejection of the lot.

4.5 Tests.

4.5.1 Resistance to boiling water. Sample shall be immersed by suspending for 30 minutes in boiling water, removed and allowed to stand for 1 hour at room temperature (68°F. - 72°F.). This cycle shall be immediately repeated three more times. The sample shall then be allowed to stand for 12 hours in air at room temperature prior to examination. Any nonconformance to the requirements of 3.8 shall be cause for rejection of the item.

4.5.2 Resistance to sulfuric acid (see 3.9).

4.5.2.1 Platter, food-serving. One platter shall be randomly selected from each lot. The platter shall be cut into four equal parts. All quarters shall be used in the test. Quarter sections shall be immersed by suspending for 10 minutes in boiling 0.8 percent (by weight) sulfuric acid, then rinsed in cold water and dried. The examination shall not include any area 1/4 inch or less from any cut (not molded) edge. Any chalking shall be cause for rejection of the item.

4.5.2.2 Other tableware items. Tableware shall be tested as specified in 4.5.2.1, except the sample shall be a complete uncut item. The examination shall include all areas of the item tested. Any chalking shall be cause for rejection of the item.

4.5.3 Warpage, food-serving platter (see 3.10).

4.5.3.1 Rim warpage. Rim warpage shall be determined by placing the platter upside down on a flat surface and holding firmly in place by a 10 pound-weight, with a diameter not to exceed 5 inches, positioned at the center of the item. In this position, the item shall be sufficiently plane so that a "feeler" gage of the specified maximum thickness (0.0625 inches) cannot be inserted at any point between the item and the flat surface. Any area allowing passage of the gage shall be cause for rejection of the item.

4.5.3.2 Warpage (other than rim). Platters shall be placed upright (position of normal use on the table) on a flat surface and loaded with a 10-pound weight as specified in 4.5.3.1. In this position the item shall be sufficiently plane so that a "feeler" gage of the maximum thickness (0.0625 inches) cannot be inserted at any point between the item and the flat surface. Any area allowing passage of the gage shall be cause for rejection of the item.

4.5.4 Resistance to dry heat. Place the tableware item in a circulating air oven for 8 hours at 170°F. The specimen shall then be removed, placed in the position of use on a table and allowed to cool normally to room temperature before examination. Any nonconformance to the requirements of 3.11 shall be cause for rejection of the item.

4.5.5 Odor (class 2 only). The tableware items shall be half-filled with boiling distilled water. A plate of glass shall be immediately placed over the rim of the specimen and weighted down to obtain good contact between rim and glass. After 5 minutes the plate of glass shall be removed and the presence or absence of odor shall be determined immediately. Any nonconformance to the requirements of 3.12 shall be cause for rejection of the item.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Tableware of like class, item, and color (excluding items 11 and 13) shall be nested in quantities of 12 and securely wrapped or bagged in kraft paper having a minimum basis weight of 30 pounds conforming to UU-P-263 or plastic film conforming to L-P-378, a minimum of 1 mil thick. The package shall be secured with tape conforming to PPP-T-42 or PPP-T-45. Items 11 and 13 shall be individually wrapped and secured as specified herein. Twelve items of the tableware shall be further packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure of boxes shall be in accordance with method II of the appendix to PPP-B-636. Alternatively, tableware of like class, item, and color shall be packaged in the most compact manner in a tray made from minimum 125 pound bursting strength fiberboard or paperboad. The tray shall then be completely wrapped in commercial plastic strength film or shrink film to produce a tight package. The film shall be a minimum 0.003-inch thick.

5.1.2 Level C. The tableware shall be packaged to insure protection during shipment and safe delivery to destination. The package and quantity per package shall be the same as that normally used by the supplier for retail distribution.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Tableware of like class, item, and color packaged as specified in 5.1, in quantities specified in table III shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant, grade V3s or V2s minimum, style RSC-L. In addition to the liner, the boxes shall be provided with top and bottom pads. The material for the liner and pads shall conform to PPP-F-320, class domestic, grade 275 minimum. Boxes shall be closed method III, waterproof sealed in accordance with method V and reinforced in accordance with the appendix to PPP-B-636, except that one strap shall be applied lengthwise and one girthwise.

5.2.2 Level B. Tableware of like class, item, and color, packaged as specified in 5.1, in quantities specified in table III shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic, grade 200 minimum, style RSC-L. In addition to the liner, the boxes shall be provided with top and bottom pads. The material for the liner and pads shall be the same as the boxes. Closure of the boxes shall be in accordance with method II of the appendix to PPP-B-636.

5.2.2.1 When specified (see 6.2) the fiberboard shipping container shall be a grade V3c, V3s or V4s fiberboard box fabricated in accordance with PPP-B-636 and closed in accordance with method III of the appendix therein.

5.2.3 Level C. The tableware packaged as specified in 5.1 shall be packed to comply with the National Motor Freight Classification rules or the Uniform Freight Classification rules.

5.3 Marking. In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, all marking shall be in accordance with 5.3.1 or 5.3.2 as specified (see 6.2).

5.3.1 Civil agencies. Marking shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military agencies. Marking shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

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TABLE III. Quantity of tableware items and unit packages within shipping containers

Item No.	Total Qty. of Items per shipping container	Number of Unit Packages per shipping container
4	144	12
5	60	5
7	144	12
8	144	12
10	144	12
11	120	10
12	72	6
13	144	12
15	144	12
16	96	8
17	144	12
18	144	12
20	144	12
24	144	12

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Tableware covered by this specification is intended to be used for the serving, dispensing, and storage of food and beverages. Class 2 material items have improved impact strength and are primarily used by the Military.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Class, item, and color required (see 1.2).
(c) Whether preproduction sample is required (see 3.2).
(d) Size of lot, if different from 4.3.1.
(e) Levels of packaging and packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(f) When weather-resistant grade fiberboard boxes are required for level B shipment (see 5.2.2.1).
(g) Marking required (see 5.3).

6.3 Deletions. Items 1, 2, 3, 6, 9, 14, and 19 of L-T-48B; items 21, 22, 23, 25 and colors coral, yellow, white, avocado, and orange of L-T-00480(GSA-FSS) have been deleted.

Custodians:

Army - GL
Air Force - 84

Review activities:

Army - MD
Navy - CG, MC

User activities:

Navy - SA

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

Civil Agency Coordinating Activities:

GSA-FSS
HEW-NIH
VA-DMS

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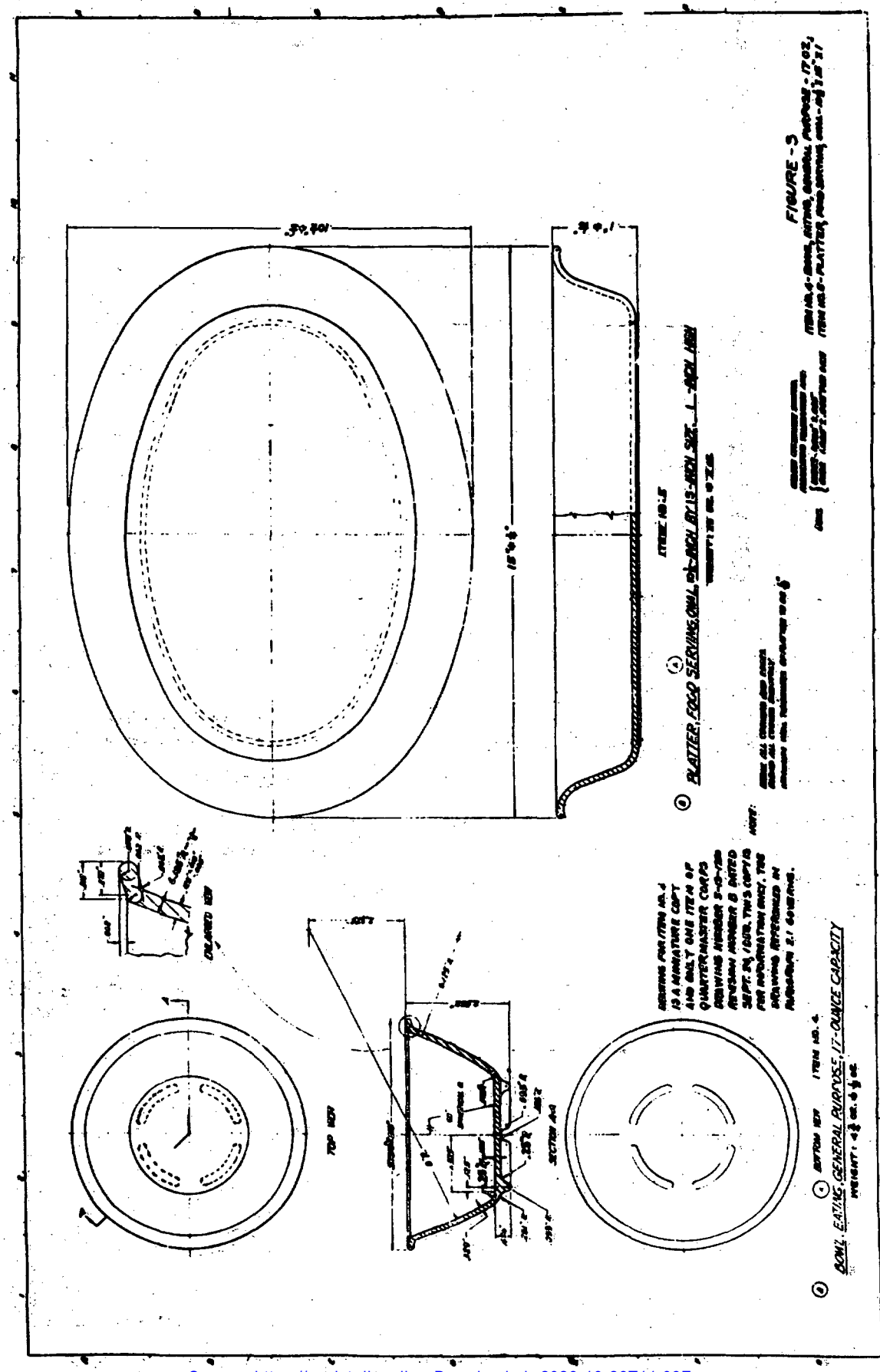


FIGURE - 3

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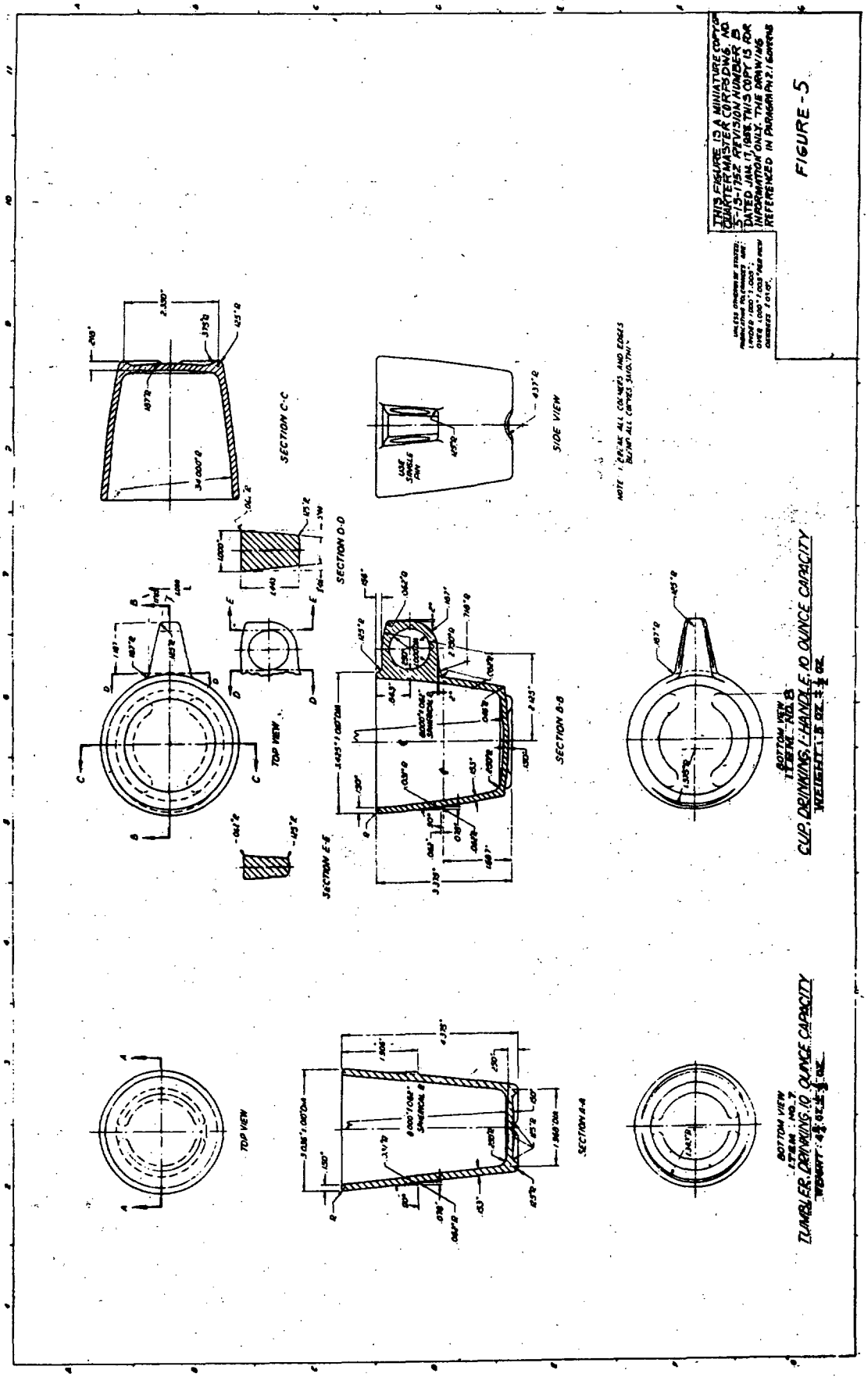
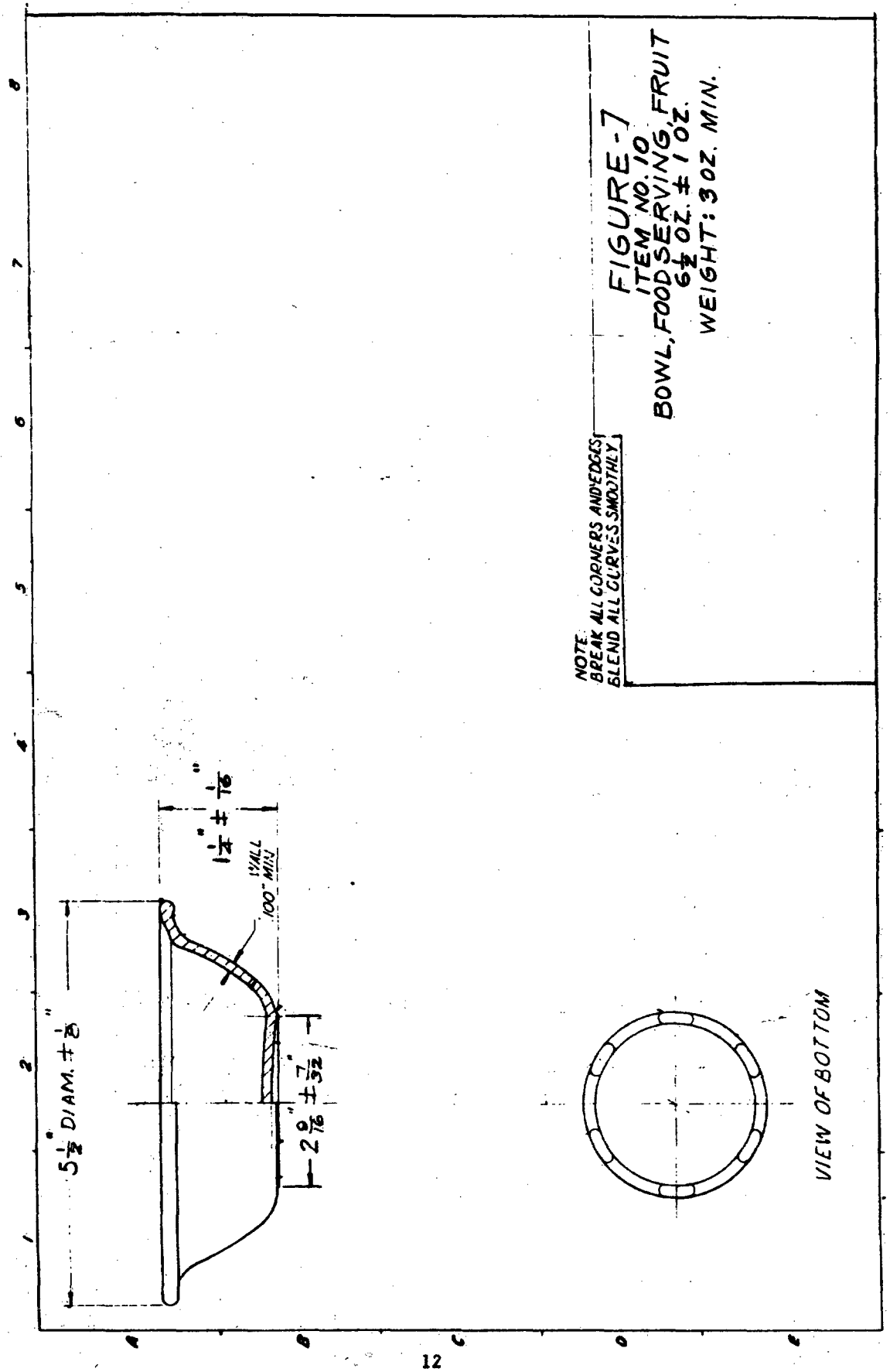
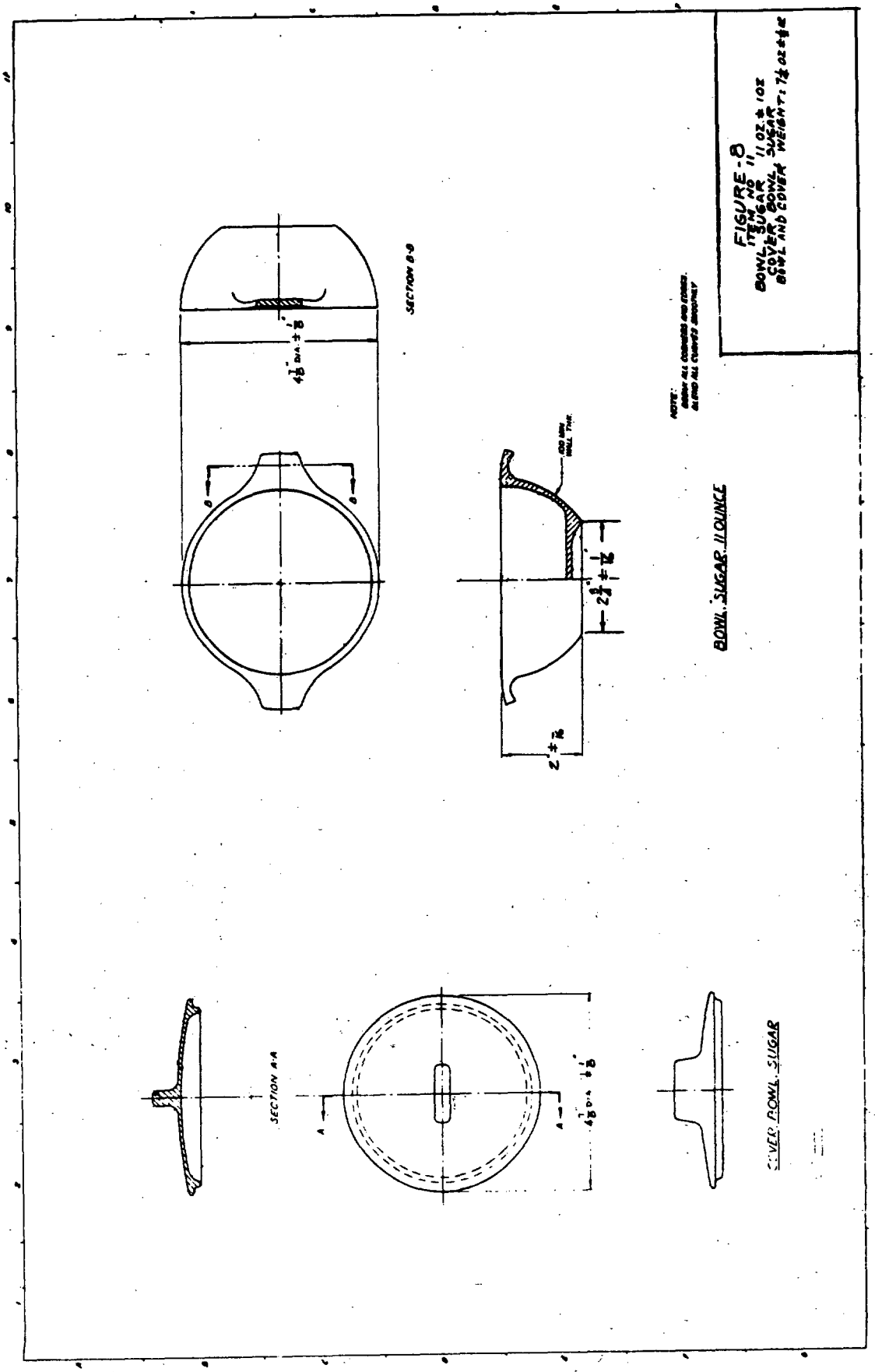


FIGURE 5

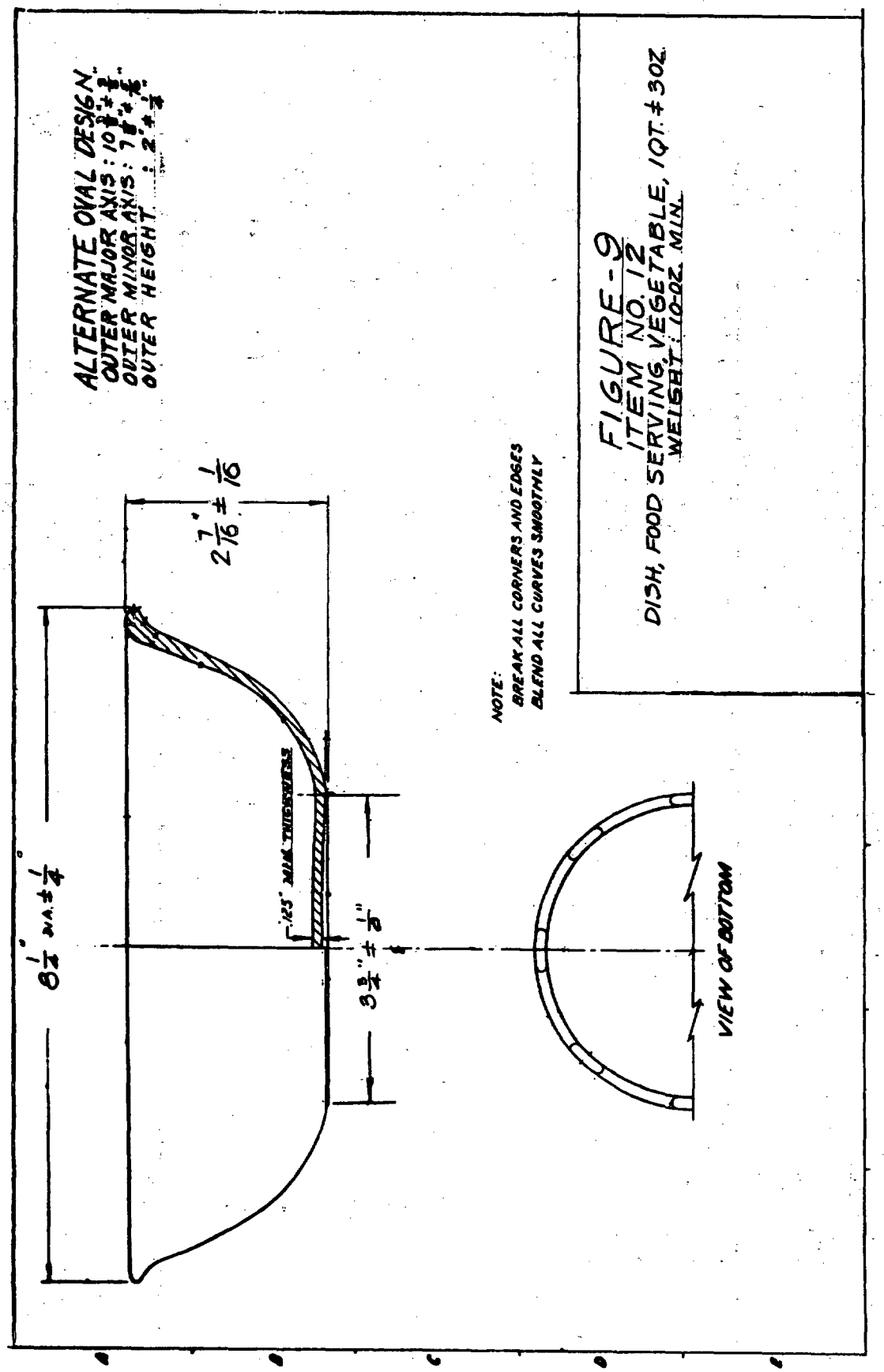
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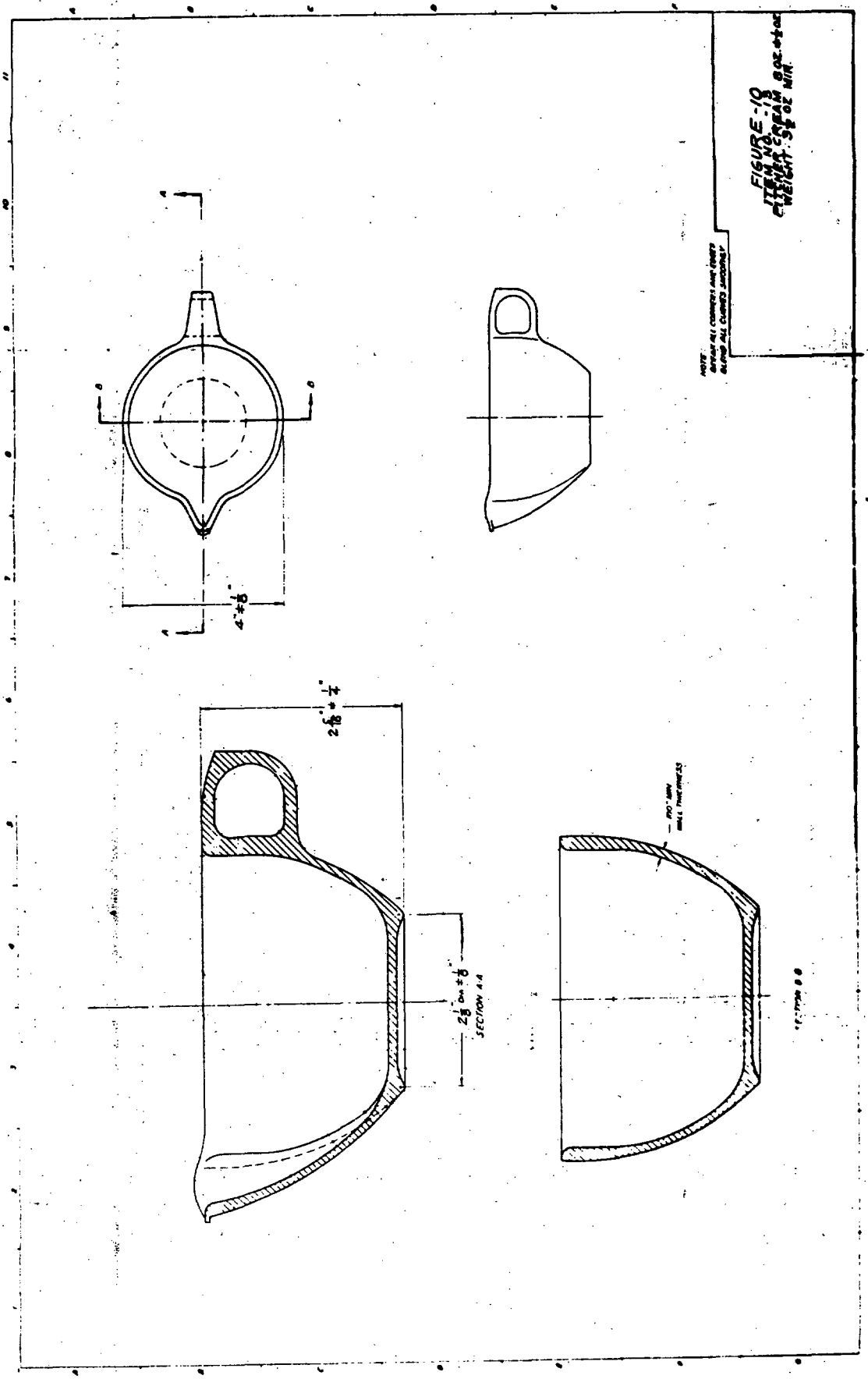
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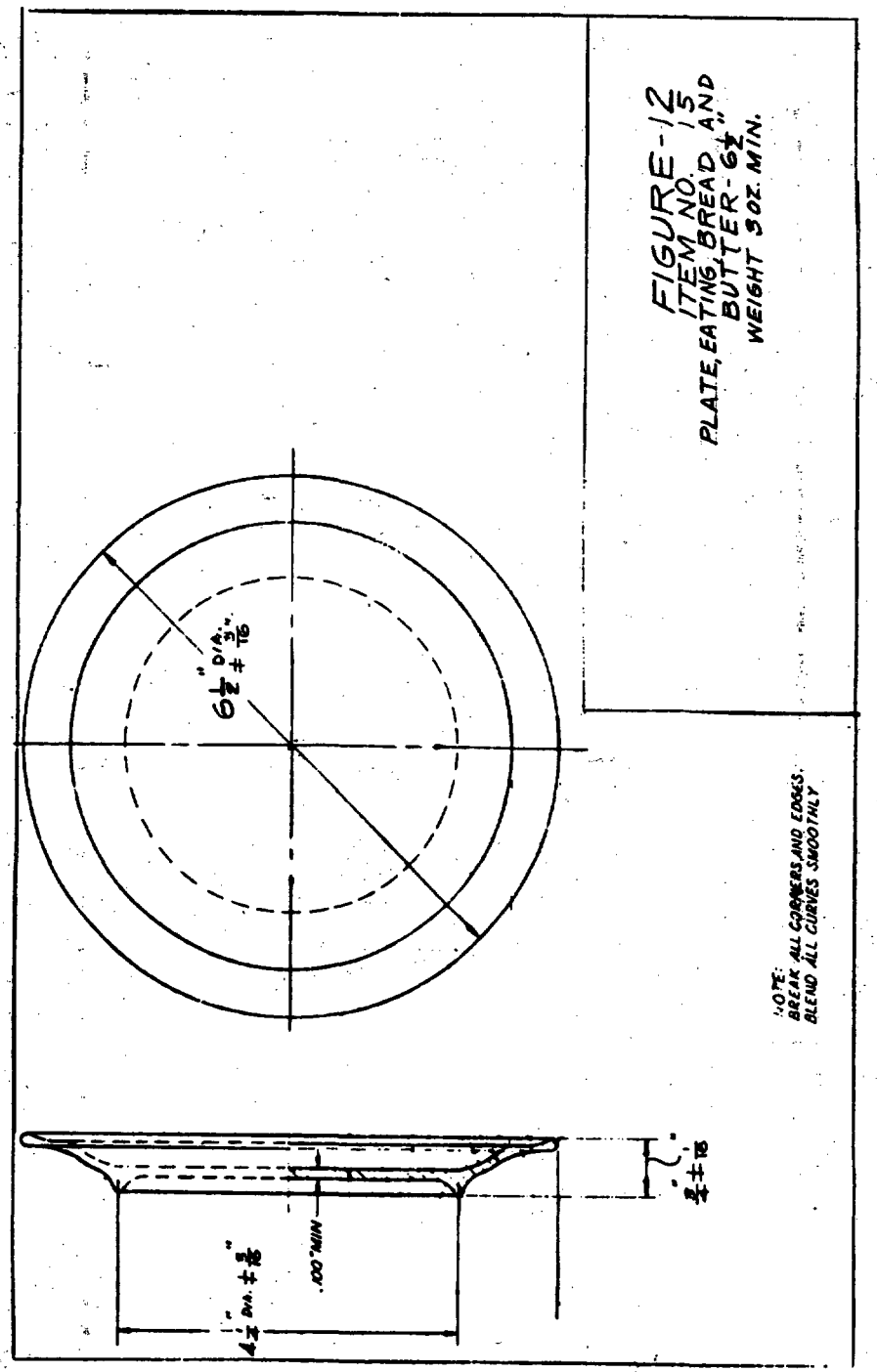
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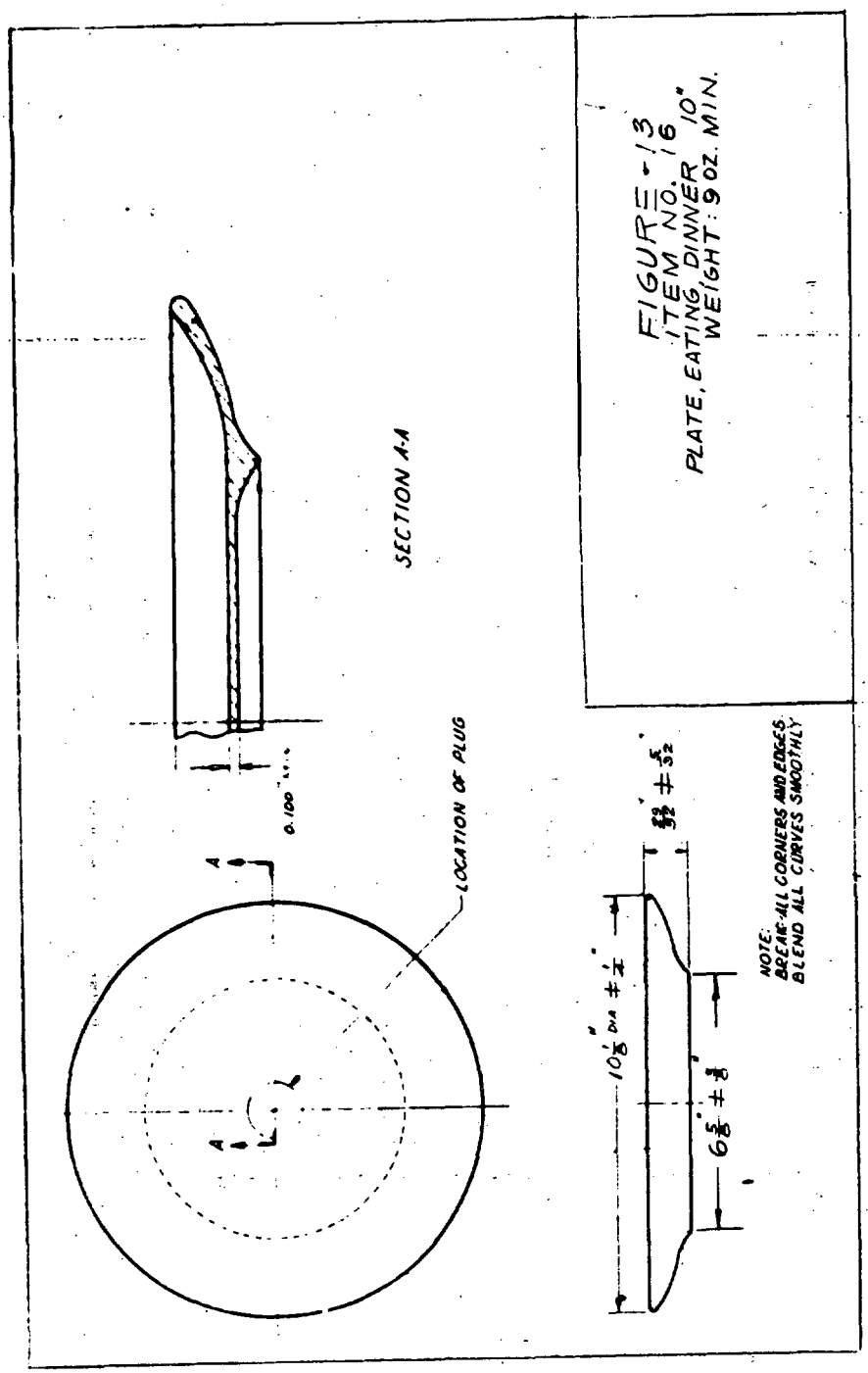
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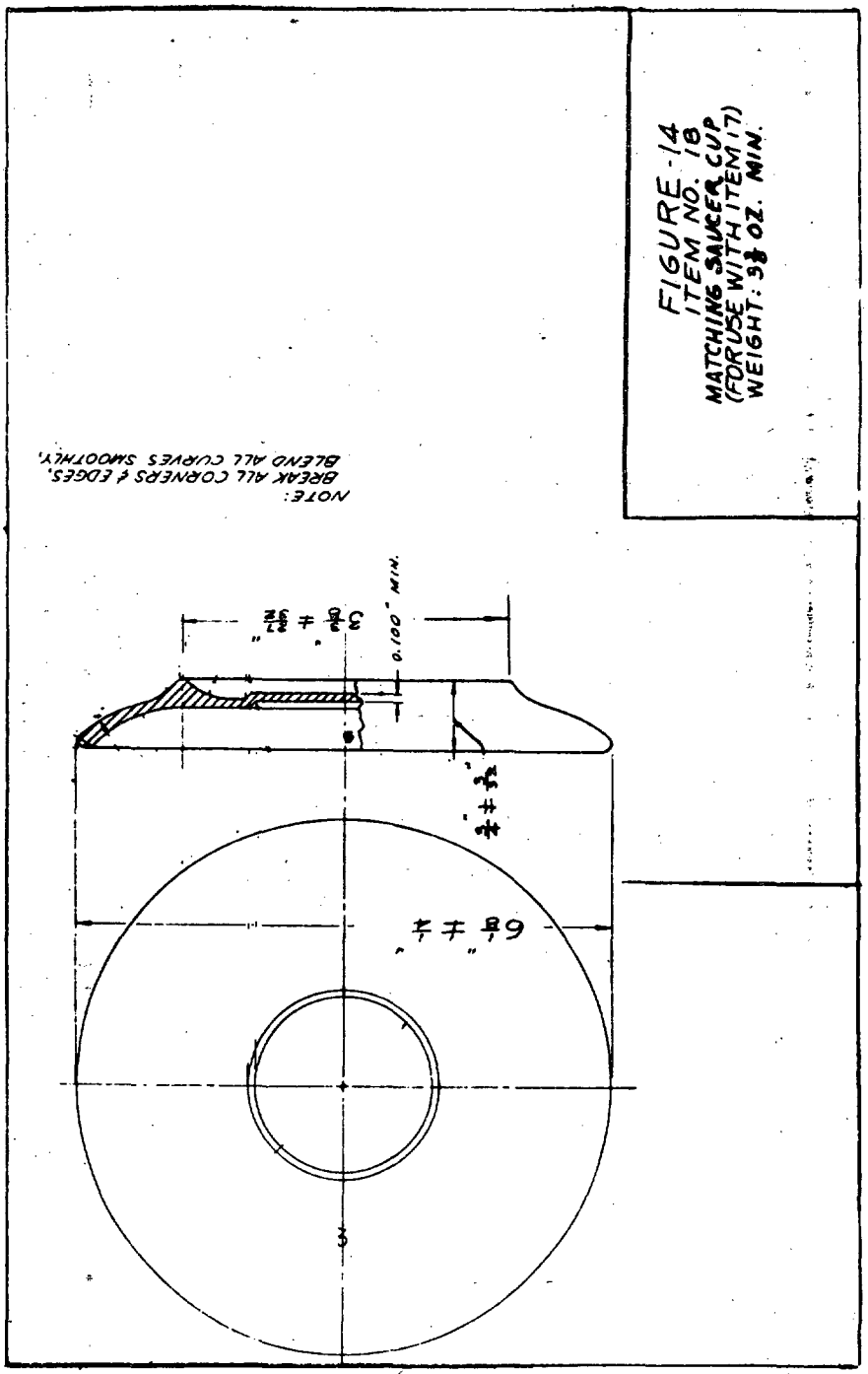
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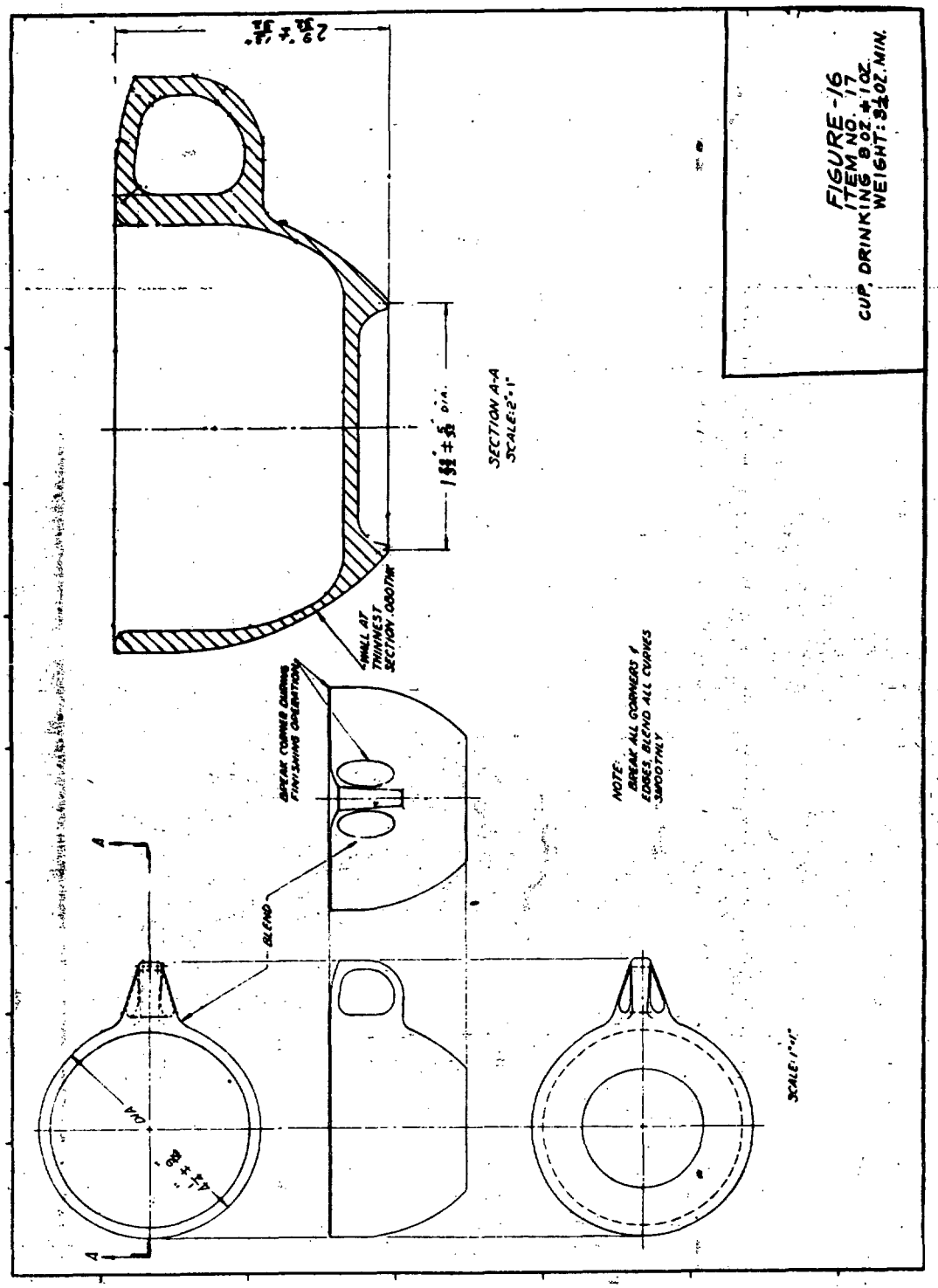
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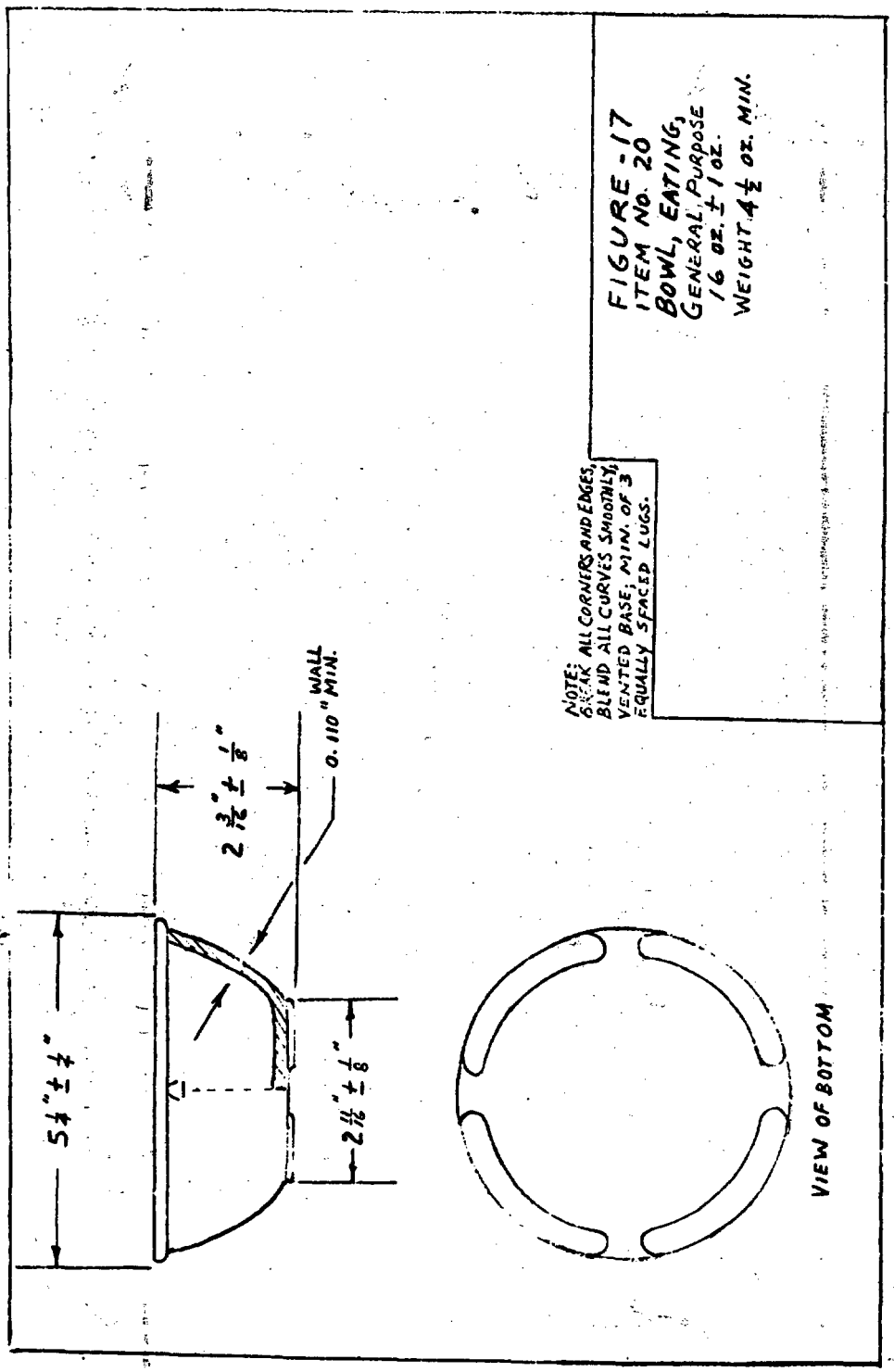
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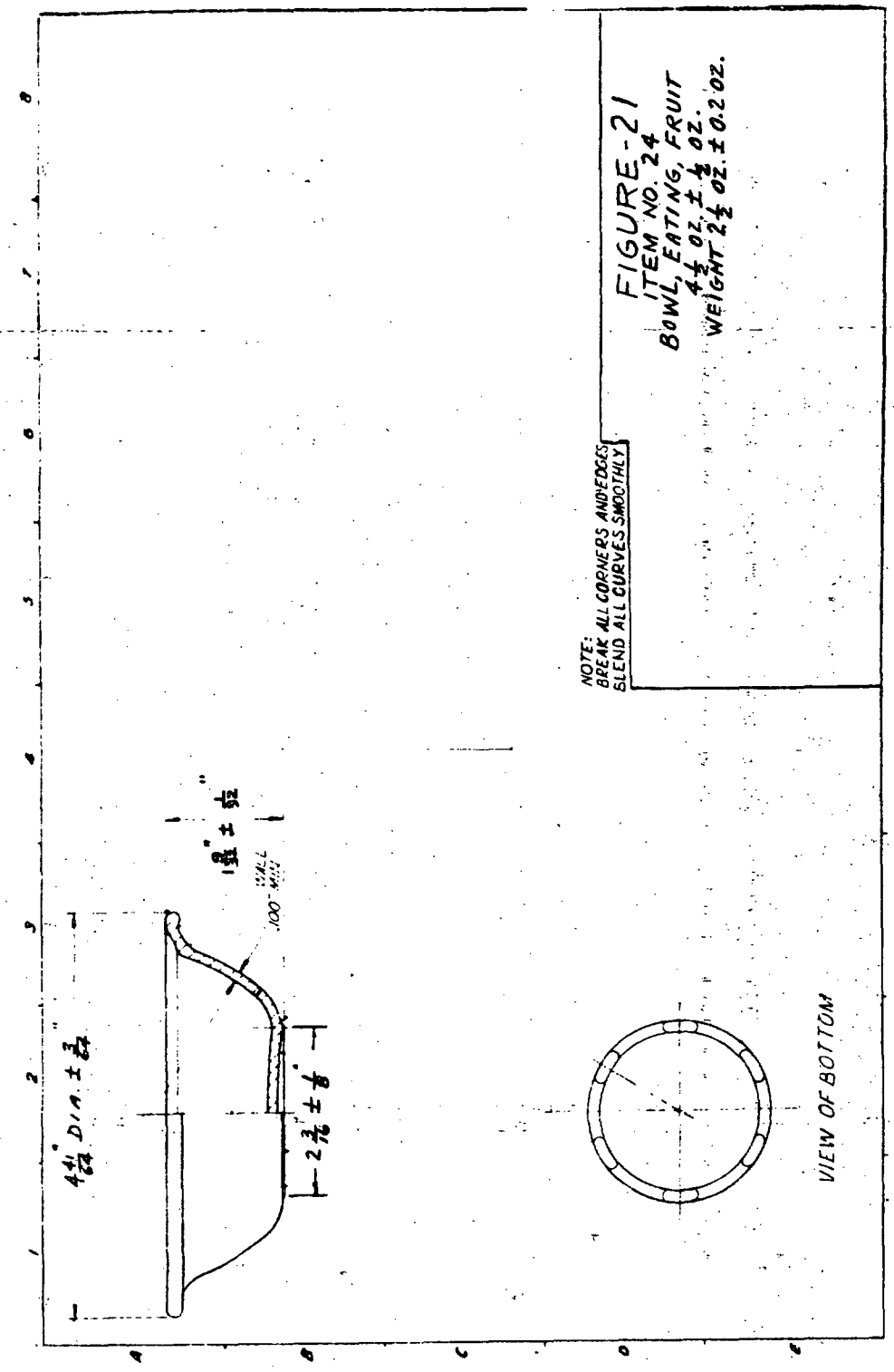
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